



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Beaver County Christian School

School Website: <https://bccspa.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**Classicality Audit: Bishop Ryan Catholic School****Executive Summary**

- Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Why: Bishop Ryan's public materials strongly emphasize Catholic worship, theology, and communal liturgical life (daily prayer, daily Mass, liturgical year), which aligns with the Religious & Metaphysical foundations of classical education. However, the site provides little-to-no evidence of a classical curriculum (Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, Latin) or pedagogy (chanting/memorization, Socratic seminars, rhetoric training). Purpose/Goal language leans toward formation (virtue, character, discipleship) but lacks explicit "truth, goodness, and beauty" articulation. Parent partnership is affirmed. Net: strong Catholic formation, weak public evidence of distinctively classical curriculum/pedagogy.
- School website reviewed: <https://bishopryan.com>

How this report was scored: All six categories below include a mandatory keyword analysis against the "Six Essential Elements of a Classical School" positive/negative keyword indicators and supporting lexicon, then a category rating (Classical / Somewhat Classical / Not Classical) with quantitative estimates. Keyword lists and guidance were drawn from the Six Essential Elements document and lexicon across multiple sections.

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS

- What the school says (site keywords/phrases found)
- "Daily Prayer," "Opportunity to attend daily Mass," "Religion classes," "Special celebrations throughout the liturgical year," "prepare future disciples," "faith-filled community"
- Comparison with Six Elements keyword lists
- Positive matches: Mass/chapel (Mass), prayer, liturgical year, catechesis/religion, communal worship, Christian formation (disciples), reverence (implicit in worship)
- Negative matches: none detected (e.g., "secular education," "religiously neutral" not present)
- Quantitative estimate
- Positive hits: 6; Negative hits: 0; Percent positive: 1.00
- Coverage (sub-areas: moral realism; theology; liturgical practice): strong evidence for theology + liturgy; partial/indirect for moral realism (no explicit "truth, goodness, beauty"); estimated coverage: 0.67
- pos_neg_hits: +6/-0
- Rating: CLASSICAL
- Justification: Robust public evidence of worship and theological integration (daily prayer, Mass, religion, liturgical year) matches liturgical/theological indicators in the Six Elements lexicon.

CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL

- What the school says (site keywords/phrases found)
- "Lives of Virtue" (page title string on site)
- "prepare future disciples," "spiritual, character and moral development" (Who We Are)
- Comparison with Six Elements keyword lists
- Positive matches: virtue, formation (character/moral development), formation toward discipleship (human flourishing/formation analog)

- Missing classical positives: no explicit “truth, goodness, beauty,” “wisdom,” “scholé,” or “great conversation” language
- Possible negative pressure: “Advanced Placement opportunities” suggests a college-prep emphasis (appears in the school’s “Who We Are” list), which the negative lexicon associates with outcomes/college-prep framing when it crowds out formation; here it is mentioned but not dominant
- Quantitative estimate
- Positive hits: 3; Negative hits: 1; Percent positive: 0.75
- Coverage: partial (formation/virtue present; T-G-B language absent); estimated coverage: 0.33
- pos_neg_hits: +3/-1
- Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Justification: Clear formation/virtue language, but under-articulated classical telos (e.g., “truth, goodness, beauty,” “wisdom”).

CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM

- What the school says (site keywords/phrases found)
- “A strong core curriculum,” “Advanced Placement opportunities” (Who We Are). No public mention found of Trivium, Quadrivium, Great Books, primary sources, Latin/Greek, or the Great Conversation
- Comparison with Six Elements keyword lists
- Missing classical positives: Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books/primary sources, classical languages, integrated humanities, wonder (not found)
- Classical negatives: none explicit (no “social studies replaces history,” no “project-based dominance” seen). AP mention is not itself a curriculum negative per se, but it can correlate with modern outcomes emphasis if dominant
- Quantitative estimate
- Positive hits: 0; Negative hits: 0; Percent positive: 0.00
- Coverage: 0.00 (no classical curriculum signals evidenced publicly)
- pos_neg_hits: +0/-0
- Rating: NOT CLASSICAL
- Justification: Absence of classical curriculum markers in public materials (Trivium, Great Books, Latin, integration/wonder language) per Six Elements indicators.

CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY OR TEACHING METHODS

- What the school says (site keywords/phrases found)
- No public mentions found of chanting/memorization, narration, Socratic seminar/disputation, scholé/restful learning, rhetoric exercises, or orations (K–12 context) in the crawl snippets captured.
- Comparison with Six Elements keyword lists
- Missing classical positives: Socratic, dialectic, chanting/memorization, scholé/rest, rhetoric, orations/-capstones (none found)
- Negatives (e.g., “project-based learning dominance,” “student-directed/constructivist,” AP-heavy rigor over rest) not explicitly present; a single AP reference exists in Who We Are but without broader pedagogical claims
- Quantitative estimate
- Positive hits: 0; Negative hits: 0; Percent positive: 0.00
- Coverage: 0.00
- pos_neg_hits: +0/-0
- Rating: NOT CLASSICAL
- Justification: No discernible classical pedagogy language on the site pages available from the crawl.

CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY

- What the school says (site keywords/phrases found)
- “Dedicated teachers” (Who We Are) but no public “portrait of a teacher,” “living curriculum,” “mentorship/collegium,” or explicit “teachers as models of virtue” language found
- Comparison with Six Elements keyword lists

- Missing classical positives: mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, collegial faculty of friends, faculty formation in classical pedagogy (not present)
- Negatives: none explicit
- Quantitative estimate
- Positive hits: 0; Negative hits: 0; Percent positive: 0.00
- Coverage: 0.00
- pos_neg_hits: +0/-0
- Rating: NOT CLASSICAL
- Justification: No public evidence that faculty are framed in explicitly classical terms or practices.

CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS AND COMMUNITY

- What the school says (site keywords/phrases found)
- “We count it our greatest privilege to partner with parents” (President’s message)
- Comparison with Six Elements keyword lists
- Positive matches: “partnership with parents” aligns to the parent partnership/co-educator emphasis in Six Elements
- Missing: explicit parent formation (book groups, classical talks), open campus invitations, liturgical year feasts for families (not evidenced publicly)
- Quantitative estimate
- Positive hits: 1; Negative hits: 0; Percent positive: 1.00
- Coverage: limited; estimated 0.33
- pos_neg_hits: +1/-0
- Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Justification: Clear partnership language; limited evidence of broader classical parent formation/community practices.

Aggregate Classification

- Category ratings: C1 Classical; C2 Somewhat Classical; C3 Not Classical; C4 Not Classical; C5 Not Classical; C6 Somewhat Classical.
- Overall assessment: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Strength: Strong Catholic liturgical/theological foundation (daily prayer, Mass, liturgical year) , which accords with classical religious-metaphysical elements.
- Gaps: Public-facing materials do not show a classical curriculum (Trivium, Great Books, Latin) or pedagogy (chanting/memorization, Socratic seminars, rhetoric).

What would move the needle (from Somewhat Classical to Classical)

- State the telos explicitly: add “truth, goodness, and beauty,” “wisdom,” “human flourishing,” and “formation (not mere information)” to mission/purpose pages and program descriptions.
 - Publish a classical curriculum map: show Trivium/Quadrivium language, list Great Books/primary sources, and name classical languages (Latin at minimum) with rationale; avoid “social studies” in favor of “history” to signal continuity with classical tradition.
 - Describe pedagogy: highlight K–8 chanting/memorization and recitation; for upper grades, publish Socratic seminar/disputation practices and rhetoric deliverables (speeches, orations, theses) and any scholé/restful learning commitments.
 - Faculty formation: add a “Portrait of a Teacher,” note faculty classical training/collegium and mentorship language.
 - Parent formation: advertise parent reading groups, “What is classical education?” nights, or book clubs to align home and school loves (affections).
 - Calibrate outcomes language: keep AP as a tool, but ensure public framing emphasizes virtue/wisdom over metrics and college-prep signals.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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